

Engine: 1.2 L petrol
Power: 83 bhp@6,000 rpm
Torque: 113.8 m@4,000 rpm
Gearbox: 5-speed MT/ AMT
Price: Rs 6-10 lakh (ex-showroom)

HYUNDAI EXTER

Photographs by HARVINDER SINGH



rear centre armrest either. At 391 litres, the boot space is quite substantial for this size, but a lack of split-folding seats restricts flexibility. Six airbags, ABS with EBD, hill-start assist, ESC and VSM, and three-point seatbelts with seatbelt reminders for all five occupants are offered as standard features.

The 1.2-litre petrol engine that powers the Exter feels refined, and the performance is more than adequate for most users, with Hyundai claiming a 0-to-100 kmph time of 12.6 seconds (manual variant). Also, based on ARAI-certified figures, it is fuel-efficient as well, with returns upwards of 19 kmpl. It's the manual variant that's the more fun to drive of the two, though the convenience of an automatic (AMT), especially when driving daily in traffic, takes precedence. The 5-speed AMT will suit the driving style of an average buyer quite well and the driver can always control shifts manually using the paddle shifters, if needed. Because of its form factor, the Exter has a very commanding driving position, offering a great view of the road ahead and making it easier for the driver to get a sense of the footprint of the car, which most buyers in the segment deem crucial. The ride quality is impressive, not just over bad roads but even on (practically) no roads, as we experienced during our time with the car.

The Exter has all the necessary styling traits of an SUV, a high ground clearance and a commanding driving position, coupled with a great ride quality. For the price, the features list is long and the Exter scores high in terms of space as well. With manual and automatic variants along with a CNG option, it caters to a wide spectrum of buyers. We'll be seeing plenty of these on the road very soon, that's for sure. ■